



Capsule wardrobes

A beginner's guide on how to start your own capsule wardrobe.
<https://digit.in/sep21-09>



Pods vs Capsules

An indepth look at the differences between coffee pods and coffee capsules
<https://digit.in/sep21-10>

the stress associated with preparing meals. This is done by only picking up the essentials and staples that work in a wide variety of meals, as against buying for one specialised meal, and keeping the extras for next time. Cutting down on waste and having more sustainable lifestyles is a part of the whole minimalism ethic that drives the need for capsule kitchens, so the food bloggers who provide the guides for maintaining capsule kitchens suggest using glass or earthen storage containers, buying fresh eggs, bread, butter, milk or biscuits that do not use plastic for packaging. The idea is that the less trash comes into the kitchen, the less trash has to go out.



REVIEWS

Think of this as a dictionary, where every listed item, which can range from a movie to a book to a game, has a review instead of a definition. The user generated reviews on e-commerce portals, hotel booking sites, social media platforms and app stores are all examples of capsule reviews. Note that the capsule reviews are entirely self-contained in a few lines. The reviews on IMDB for example are capsule reviews, but the ones on Rotten Tomatoes are pull quotes and the ones on Metacritic are snippets, and cannot be considered real capsule reviews. Writing capsule reviews is an art form in itself, and if you want an example of an exhaustive list of movies, look no further than Shreeux's Movie Chronicles on the Digit Forum, with over 2000 capsule reviews posted over a period of seven years! (<https://digit.in/shreeux>).



HOTELS

Capsule hotels are a hospitality trend that originated in Japan, and are more similar to hostels than hotels. Each guest has their own pod, with is a walled off environment within which they can rest or read. All belongings are checked into lockers outside the pod or safes

inside the pod. There are common restrooms, dining and lounge areas. Some pod hotels offer audiovisual systems and wi-fi connectivity within the pod, while others may have shared working spaces as well. Capsule hotels are a low cost accommodation option aimed at students, tourists and visiting workers. There are a few real capsule hotels in India, that give the experience similar to living in cramped quarters onboard a submarine or a spaceship such as Qubestay or Urbanpod. However, be wary of listings of low cost hotels with beds or even bunkbeds, but without the walling off for privacy or any of the smart features, with the "capsule" being an imaginary construct around your bed.



An Urbanpod capsule



COFFEE

Brewing a cup of coffee is a time consuming process, and the instant coffee or the coffee bags are just as bad as detergent pods in comparison. There are few options available to get a regular dose of coffee at home, either try mastering the pour over technique used to make filter coffee on the streetsides or get a single serve coffee machine. What these machines do is heat water at just the right temperature to bring out the flavour from the beans, and squeeze the water in a high pressure jet, through pods of ground coffee, into the cup. Coffee pods have just enough coffee for serving a single cup of coffee, and are meant to be convenient and fast. Now here is where things get tricky. In the coffee world, pods are not the same

as capsules. Pods are open standards that anyone can use to provide the mix for coffee, while capsules are proprietary, and locked into the manufacturer of the machine. A number of different manufacturers can make the coffee pods, but the capsules are locked in to a single one. The patent for the capsules on one of the most common manufacturers, Nespresso expired in 2012, which is now used by a number of coffee companies for making their pods.



SPACE

Space capsules are the primary way in which crewed missions can go on space missions now, since the retirement of the Shuttle program. The SpaceX

Crew Dragon is all set to be in the news this month with the first spaceflight entirely occupied by civilians, is expected to spend three days in orbit. Another tourist Crew Dragon mission scheduled for later in

the year, the Space Adventures mission will attempt to break the Earth orbital altitude record, by venturing three times beyond the altitude of the International Space Station. NASA is in the process of building three "Orion" crew capsules that are to be used in the ambitions Artemis missions, where humans will set foot on the Moon again. At the same time the Boeing Starliner is also being developed for crewed and resupply missions to the International Space Station, with the first test crewed flight scheduled for early next year. If all goes well though, the most exciting space capsule missions could be from closer back home. The developmental test flights for ISRO's crew capsule, Gaganyaan are expected to take place early next year, with the first crewed flight in 2023. 🚀